

# The 6:15

TUESDAY · AUGUST 25, 2026

NO. 6

## THE BOARD

### CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tue 8/25</b> | Dick's Sporting Goods (DKS) premkt, ~7:00a ET — cons. EPS \$3.76–3.80, rev. \$5.64B; Intuit (INTU) FQ4/FY26 aft. close; Yankees host Astros, 7:05p                                                                                       |
| <b>Wed 8/26</b> | Nvidia (NVDA) aft. close — cons. rev. \$92.07B, EPS \$2.09; Salesforce, CrowdStrike aft. close; Q2 GDP 2nd estimate, July PCE price index, durable goods, 8:30a (BEA); Lisa Cook's deadline to respond to Trump's renewed removal letter |
| <b>Thu 8/27</b> | Marvell (MRVL) aft. close; jobless claims, 8:30a; Jackson Hole symposium opens (thru 8/29) — theme "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy"                                                                          |
| <b>Fri 8/28</b> | Fed Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole keynote, 10:00a ET                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Fri 9/4</b>  | August jobs report (nonfarm payrolls), 8:30a (BLS)                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Tue 9/16</b> | Next FOMC decision                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

[DEVELOPING] Anthropic is preparing to publicly file its S-1 as soon as this week, targeting an October IPO at a reported ~\$2T valuation against its \$965B May Series H. **(Valuation reported, not company-confirmed.)** No confirmed rocket launch or new frontier AI model this window beyond items already logged.

### METRICS · TIMES ET UNLESS NOTED

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Brent / WTI / spread</b>         | Settled \$92.06 (–2.5%) / \$85.19 (–2.15%) Mon 8/24 close; ~\$6.87 spread. Tue premkt indicative ~\$92.30s / ~\$85.60s, little changed <b>(no fresh settle yet)</b> |
| <b>UST 2y / 10y / 30y</b>           | 4.19% / 4.70% / 5.23% (Fed H.15, Mon 8/24 close)                                                                                                                    |
| <b>DXY</b>                          | 99.07 (+0.11%, Tue AM)                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>S&amp;P / Nasdaq-100 futures</b> | +0.12% / +0.37% (Tue premkt)                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>VIX</b>                          | 15.85 (Mon close, +4.76% vs. Fri)                                                                                                                                   |

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|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Gold (spot)</b>            | ~\$4,650 (Mon close, near 3-mo high, fiscal-debasement trade); \$4,637 (–0.3%, Tue AM indicative) |
| <b>S&amp;P / Dow / Nasdaq</b> | 7,652.86 (–0.3%) / 53,417.16 (+0.3%) / 25,980.19 (–0.8%) — Mon close, pre-Nvidia chip selloff     |
| <b>Nikkei / Hang Seng</b>     | 65,713 +0.28% / –0.28% (Tue Asia close)                                                           |
| <b>STOXX 600 / DAX</b>        | –0.1% / ~26,133 (Mon close) — Tue session still open at press time, no close yet                  |
| <b>Retail gas, natl. avg.</b> | \$4.099/gal (AAA, 8/24)                                                                           |

#### HORMUZ COUNTERS

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|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Closure</b>          | Day 177 (straits.live, 10:12 UTC 8/25)                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Transits</b>         | Kpler: 7 vessels Thu 8/21 (4 in, 3 out). Lloyd's List: 73 transits 8/10–16 vs. 91 prior wk. PortWatch: 1 vessel 8/16 vs. 73/day baseline ( <b>all three &gt;1 wk stale</b> )                                                                  |
| <b>Backlog</b>          | ~520 vessels stuck in Arabian Gulf, up to 8-wk clear time ( <b>single-sourced, unchanged since 8/23</b> )                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Strikes</b>          | 64 documented incidents crisiswide thru 8/18 (Wikipedia tracker, wire-aggregated), plus unclaimed strike on tanker Metro Venetian, 9nm off Ash Shishah, Oman, overnight 8/23–24 (UKMTO) — engine room disabled, crew safe, no attribution yet |
| <b>War-risk premium</b> | VLCC ~\$10M/passages, ~40× the ~\$250K peacetime rate (straits.live, 8/25) — consistent w/ Lloyd's List/Marsh's \$10–14M range, late July                                                                                                     |
| <b>Dark tankers</b>     | <b>not confirmed as of press time</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

Kpler's near-real-time AIS daily counts, Lloyd's List's slower weekly commercial-transit aggregation (>10,000 dwt, Iran-link attributed, revised as "dark transits" are identified), and PortWatch's baseline-comparison snapshots measure different things over different windows — don't net them against each other.

#### TRANSACTIONS

|                              |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Yankees</b>               | No new moves in last 24h. McMahon (thumb) & Fried (elbow) remain on IL; on Stanton (calf), Boone said Monday club is "not ruling anything out" but a season return will be difficult      |
| <b>Knicks / Northwestern</b> | Hart's reported 3-yr/\$60–62M extension still unsigned. Northwestern confirmed its Sept. 5 opener will be played at a temporary Martin Stadium facility; rebuilt Ryan Field debuts Oct. 2 |

## **Bessent's "Economic D-Day" lands as a warning shot, not a trigger — and markets read it that way.**

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent used Monday's press conference to formally unveil "Operation Economic Outcast," the sanctions campaign the administration had spent days branding an "Economic D-Day" against Iran. The mechanism: Treasury sanctioned nearly 60 entities, individuals and vessels tied directly to Iran's nuclear- and missile-technology procurement, cyber operations and oil smuggling, while separately expanding the categories eligible for secondary sanctions — penalties on third parties who keep doing business with Tehran — into five new fields: digital assets, technology, gold, aviation and shipping. Bessent framed the goal explicitly as regime collapse rather than containment, saying the aim is to "sever every economic lifeline that sustains this tyrannical regime until Tehran stands alone."

What actually distinguishes Monday from five months of prior warnings is what Bessent didn't do: he declined to set a compliance deadline for the countries most exposed — reportedly China, India, Turkey, Iraq and the UAE, the last of which had already cut its own economic ties to Iran ten days earlier over missile strikes on its territory. "I'm not going to set a timeline, but we do not have infinite patience here," Bessent said, calling the announcement a "warning shot" and adding, "we are giving everyone the opportunity to remedy bad behavior." (*Read: that's the single fact that mattered most to markets Monday — a campaign billed for weeks as a knockout blow*

*arrived instead as a notice period, with enforcement timing left open-ended.)*

Oil's reaction confirms the read. Brent, which had run up through the prior week on anticipation of the announcement, gave back ground to settle at \$92.06 Monday (-2.5%); WTI settled \$85.19 (-2.15%). That is the standard sell-the-news pattern for an event markets had already priced as escalatory before it arrived undercut by its own hedging language. (*Read.*) Equities took the news in stride for the same reason — the Dow actually rose 0.3% Monday — with the more consequential story for stocks turning out to be Wednesday's Nvidia print rather than Monday's sanctions rollout: the Nasdaq fell 0.8% on a chip-stock selloff unconnected to Iran.

Tehran's response leaned into the same performative register now standard on both sides. Finance Minister Ali Madanizadeh said the government has “a two-year plan” and is “fully prepared,” a rhetorical echo of Foreign Minister Araghchi's framing from last week — that U.S. pressure campaigns have failed before and this one masks Washington's own fiscal strain — which went unchanged Monday. (*Continuity: Araghchi's framing already logged 8/23, no new specifics this run.*)

The second-order consequence worth watching isn't Monday's language but the list of countries named as exposed. China is Iran's largest trading partner and top oil buyer; naming Beijing alongside India, Turkey and Iraq as targets for secondary sanctions — even without a deadline — sets up a compliance test Washington cannot easily win against any of the four without risking a parallel trade fight, on top of the reciprocal-tariff dispute already opening with Canada (see Business). That the UAE turns up on the same at-risk list despite having already zeroed out its own Iran trade underscores

how blunt an instrument “secondary sanctions” now is relative to what’s actually happening on the water — where the marginal pressure on Tehran is coming less from Washington’s paperwork than from the seizure-and-strike campaign in the strait itself, which continued through the weekend independent of anything Bessent announced Monday.

## **POLITICS**

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Lisa Cook’s deadline to respond to Trump’s renewed removal effort lands Wednesday, per Deputy Chief of Staff Dan Scavino’s Aug. 5 letter, which requires her to submit evidence and arguments through the Director of Presidential Personnel by Aug. 26. Her attorney, Abbe Lowell, has already signaled her response: the mortgage-fraud allegations underlying the removal effort are “as baseless now as they were a year ago.” (*Continuity, unchanged stance.*) The Wednesday deadline runs on a separate track from the Supreme Court’s own review of Trump’s removal authority, which the Court in June ruled requires notice and an opportunity to respond before any for-cause removal, and which it has since agreed to hear on the merits with argument set for January. (*Read: Wednesday tests whether Trump moves to remove her again before the Court rules on his authority to do so at all — a decision that would restart the emergency-litigation cycle that already reached the Court once this year, this time arriving the same morning as the Q2 GDP/PCE data cluster and hours ahead of Nvidia’s earnings, crowding a Fed-independence story into a news cycle markets are watching for entirely different reasons.*) The House-Senate government funding gap — the Senate’s continuing resolution runs to Dec. 11, the House’s own version only to Dec. 4 — remains unresolved, with the

House still in recess and neither side signaling new urgency.  
*(Unchanged, no new movement.)*

## ECONOMICS

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Wednesday's data cluster is the week's real macroeconomic test. The Q2 GDP second estimate revises an advance reading that already ran hot: 1.5% annualized growth alongside a 5.1% headline PCE inflation print and 3.4% core, both accelerations that the durable-goods component (+6.9%, driven by autos and furniture) is not expected to repeat in the second half. The July PCE price index — the Fed's preferred inflation gauge — lands the same 8:30a morning, a separate release from the GDP report's own price component. *(Read: a GDP revision confirming headline inflation running near 5% two days before a "blank piece of paper" Jackson Hole keynote from a still-new Fed chair is the kind of setup that can move the front end of the curve sharply in either direction, particularly with September's FOMC meeting only three weeks out.)* Jackson Hole itself opens Thursday under the theme "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy," with roughly 120 central bankers, economists and officials from more than 70 countries expected to attend. Warsh's Friday address is his first Jackson Hole keynote as Fed chair, arriving 19 days ahead of the Sept. 16 FOMC decision; Warsh has publicly declined to characterize the speech in advance, calling it "a blank piece of paper" and saying he has not decided between a big-picture address and a traditional forward-guidance framing.

## BUSINESS

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Monday's equity session diverged sharply by index — the Dow rose 0.3% to 53,417.16, the S&P fell 0.3% to 7,652.86, and the Nasdaq dropped 0.8% to 25,980.19 — as chip stocks sold off heading into Wednesday's Nvidia report (cons. revenue \$92.07B, EPS \$2.09, which would mark roughly 95% year-over-year growth) and as U.S.-Canada trade talks reportedly broke down, raising the prospect of reciprocal tariffs between the two countries. (*New: U.S.-Canada trade friction.*) Separately, Anthropic is preparing to publicly file its S-1 registration statement as soon as this week, aiming for an October listing at a reported \$2 trillion valuation — more than double its \$965 billion May Series H, on a run rate that reached \$65 billion at the end of July — with CNBC reporting the filing will disclose AI backlash as an explicit risk factor. (*Developing.*) **(Valuation target reported, not company-confirmed.)** Dick's Sporting Goods reports before Tuesday's open, with the Street modeling \$5.64 billion in revenue (+54.6% Y/Y, largely reflecting the Foot Locker acquisition rolling into the comp base) against EPS of \$3.76–3.80; Intuit follows after Tuesday's close with its fiscal Q4 and full-year results.

## TECHNOLOGY

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Chipmakers led Monday's Nasdaq decline as investors de-risked into Nvidia's Wednesday print, the highest-stakes single earnings event of the week for the broader AI trade. The reported \$92.07 billion revenue consensus, if hit, would represent roughly 95% year-over-year growth — a deceleration from the triple-digit rates Nvidia posted through most of the past two years, even as absolute dollar growth continues to climb. (*Read: the size of Monday's pre-earnings chip selloff suggests positioning has turned defensive into the print, which cuts both ways for Wednesday — less room for a “sell the*

*news” reaction if Nvidia beats and raises guidance, more room for a violent downside move if it merely meets expectations.)* Marvell reports Thursday as the week’s other closely watched semiconductor data point, with the AI capital-expenditure cycle broadly — from hyperscaler data-center buildouts to custom silicon demand — the through-line investors are trying to read across both prints. No new frontier-model release or confirmed rocket launch surfaced this run beyond items already logged in prior issues.

## GEOPOLITICS

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Russia and Ukraine traded their heaviest exchange in days overnight Sunday into Monday. Ukrainian drones struck 66 targets inside Russia, including a MiG-29 fighter jet near Dolotinka in Rostov Oblast, radar systems and the Kombinat Kamenskiy defense-industrial facility; falling debris from a downed drone killed two children and injured seven more, plus two adults, at a childcare center in Krasnodar. Russia's overnight response included two Oniks anti-ship missiles, six Kh-31P and Kh-59 guided air-launched missiles and 143 drones, striking across ten Ukrainian regions including Sumy, Kharkiv, Zaporizhzhia and Kherson. Putin said Sunday that Ukraine's strikes on economic targets — including the prior week's hit on retailer Ozon's Samara Oblast warehouse — had opened “Pandora's box,” a rhetorical escalation from his earlier promise of “far more destructive” retaliation against Ukrainian economic infrastructure. (*Developing.*) Xi's Sept. 24 Washington summit remains on the calendar with export controls the unresolved friction point; no new developments surfaced this run.

## IRAN & HORMUZ

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Oman's foreign minister, Sayyid Badr al-Busaidi, visits Tehran Tuesday to discuss the strait and “other developments in the region” — the most direct diplomatic channel still open between a Gulf state and Iran, and notable given Muscat's role as the last consistent go-between in this conflict. The visit comes days after Iran's state Persian Gulf Strait Authority warned Sunday that vessels violating its new transit-permit and toll rules face “detention or confiscation” — the enforcement threat that the Amara seizure and the unclaimed

Metro Venetian strike both appear designed to demonstrate. No fresher status update on the still-detained Amara was located this run beyond its confirmed continued hold near Qeshm Island as of Aug. 21; whether it remains there four days on is unconfirmed as of press time. **(Stale.)** The threat classification across the strait remains at its tightest reading of the five-month crisis, unchanged since the last issue.

SPORTS

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|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Yankees      | Beat Toronto 8-3 Sun 8/23 (Rice's two-run single capped a three-run sixth; Chisholm, Grisham added HRs); off Mon 8/24. Host Houston tonight, 7:05p. 74-56, 2nd AL East, 3.5 GB Tampa Bay. |
| Knicks       | Off-season, no game. Hart extension talks ongoing (see Transactions) — still unsigned.                                                                                                    |
| Northwestern | Off-season, no game. Opener remains Sat 9/5, 7:00p CT vs. South Dakota State, now confirmed for a temporary Martin Stadium facility (see Transactions).                                   |

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**Continuity.** Dropped as unchanged since 8/23: Khamenei/IRGC command reshuffle, Oman shipping-lane routing map, TSMC July revenue, Microsoft's Maia chip order reporting, Araghchi's standard rhetorical framing, the House-Senate funding gap. For next issue: Nvidia earnings Wed. aft. close is the week's single biggest swing factor for the AI trade; Q2 GDP 2nd estimate/July PCE and Lisa Cook's Wednesday deadline both land the same morning; Jackson Hole opens Thursday, Warsh's keynote Friday; watch for a fresher Hormuz transit count and Amara's status past Aug. 21.

**Unverified figures** are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.